

Sayorn Chin

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Last Update: May 27, 2026

VISA STATUS	Cambodia: Citizenship, United States: Permanent Resident	
CURRENT POSITIONS	Assistant Professor , Department of Economics, Lafayette College	Jul. 2023 – Present
	Data Science Fellow Affiliate , Mountain Data Group	Jun. 2023 – Present
PREVIOUS POSITIONS	Data Scientist , Mountain Data Group	May 2021 – May 2023
	Graduate Teaching Instructor , Colorado State University	Jul. 2020 – May 2023
	Graduate Teaching Assistant , Colorado State University	Aug. 2017 – May 2020
	Finance Assistant , Colorado College	Feb. 2016 – Jan. 2017
	Data Research Analyst , Colorado College	Jan. 2016 – May 2016
EDUCATION	Ph.D., Economics , Colorado State University	2023
	M.A., Economics , Colorado State University	2019
	B.A., Mathematical Economics , Colorado College	2017
RESEARCH OUTPUT	Peer-Reviewed Publications: Economics	
	[1] Chin, S., & Miller, R. (2026). Beyond income: Health, wealth, and racial welfare gaps among older Americans. <i>Demography</i> , 63(1), 187–211. <i>Demography</i> is the flagship journal of the Population Association of America.	
	[2] An, Y., Chin, S., & Miller, R. (2025). Growing old in rural America: Measuring late-life health and economic well-being. <i>The Journal of the Economics of Ageing</i> , 31, 100565.	
	[3] Miller, R., Chin, S., & Sedai, A. K. (2022). The welfare cost of late-life depression. <i>Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization</i> , 204, 15–36.	
	Peer-Reviewed Publications: Public Health	
	[1] Perry, T., & Chin, S. (2026). The unregulated rise of kratom drinks: Emerging challenges and policy recommendations. <i>Public Health Reports</i> , 1–6. <i>Public Health Reports</i> is the flagship journal of the Office of the U.S. Surgeon General and the U.S. Public Health Service.	
	[2] Perry, T., & Chin, S. (2026). Kratom drinks and consumption trends: Insights from Reddit. <i>Journal of Substance Use</i> , 31(1), 124–132.	
	[3] Perry, T., & Chin, S. (2025). Kratom beverages online: Marketing narratives, content, dosing, and potential risks. <i>Substance Use & Misuse</i> , 1–4.	
	Peer-Reviewed Publications: Economics Pedagogy	
	[1] Chin, S., Io, K., Kırşanlı, F., & Perry, T. (2026). From cheating to learning: AI integration in introductory economics. <i>Journal of Economics Teaching</i> .	

Working Papers

- [1] Loss or Gain from Separation? Wealth and Child Mental Health in Divorce Dynamics, with Solano Caffarena, Swarup Joshi, and Ashish Sedai. *Under Review*.
- [2] The Compensation of Conscience, with Sammy Zahran and Anders Fremstad. *Under Review*.
- [3] The Longer Reach of Lead: Early Childhood Lead Exposure and Cognitive Ability Later-in-Life, with Christopher Keyes, Sammy Zahran, and David Mushinski. *Under Review*.
- [4] Further Evidence of the Effects of Air Pollution on Crime, with Salvador Lurbé and Prasiddha Shakya.
- [5] The Effect of Leaded Gasoline on Infant Health: Evidence from NASCAR Fuel Transition, with Yuulin An and Sammy Zahran.
- [6] Maternal Lead Exposure and Birth Outcomes: Evidence from Natural Experiments in the Phase-out of Leaded Gasoline, with Sammy Zahran, Christopher Keyes, and Yuulin An.

Work in Progress

- [1] Lead Exposure and Heart-Disease Mortality in the United States, with Christopher Keyes, Bruce Lanphear, and Sammy Zahran.
- [2] Tip Credit Effects on Employment, Earnings, and Establishments, with Vinicius Curti Cícero and Sammy Zahran.
- [3] The Morning Advantage: Differential Returns to Sunlight Exposure on Well-being, with Sammy Zahran and Ray Miller.
- [4] Excess Emissions and Infant Health: Evidence from Texas, with Susan Averett.
- [5] Urban Heat Island and Birth Complications, with Yuulin An and Tim Komarek.
- [6] Bringing Introductory Economics to Life: A Scaffolded Research Paper as Authentic Assessment in Introductory Economics, with Teresa Perry, Fatih Kırşanlı, and Kenese Io.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lafayette College

ECON 215: Health Economics	FA 2025
ECON 346: Economic Development	FA 2024, SP 2025, FA 2025, SP 2026
ECON 251: Intermediate Microeconomics	FA 2023, SP 2024, FA 2024, SP 2025, SP 2026

Colorado State University

ECON 202: Principles of Microeconomics	FA 2017, FA 2019, SM 2020, FA 2021 SP 2022, FA 2022, SP 2023
ECON 204: Principles of Macroeconomics	SP 2018, FA 2018, SP 2019 SP 2020, FA 2020
ECON 306: Intermediate Microeconomics	FA 2021, SP 2022
ECON 304: Intermediate Macroeconomics	SP 2021
ECON 335: Introduction to Econometrics	SM 2019
ECON 460: Economic Development	FA 2021

RESEARCH ADVISING	Honors Thesis Advising Daniel Colden ('26) - Economics and History (Primary Advisor) Benjamin Risley ('26) - Government and Law, Economics (Second Reader) Independent Study Isabel Berkeley ('25) Spring 2025 Xinyuan Liang ('27) Spring 2025 Yi Luo ('26) Spring 2025 Justin Fretz ('25) Spring 2025 EXCEL Scholars/Bergh Fellows/Research Assistants Yi Luo ('26) Fall 2025 Ava Sydell ('27) Summer 2025 Daniel Colden ('26) Winter 2025 Naya Kurdy ('25) Fall 2024, Spring 2025 Vanika Sok ('26) Summer 2024, Fall 2024
COLLEGE SERVICE	Artificial Intelligence Club Advisor Summer 2025 – Present International Faculty & Staff Community of Practice Board Member Spring 2025 – Present
DEPARTMENT SERVICE	Scholarship Revision Working Group Fall 2025 – Present Co-organizer Department Honors Program Fall 2024 – Present
HONORS AND AWARDS	Student Government Superior Teaching Awards Nominee, Lafayette College 2024 Graduate Research Assistantship, Colorado State University 2022 Competition Committee Member, AFIT-AFEE 16th Annual Student Scholars Award 2022 Best Paper Award, AFIT-AFEE 16th Annual Student Scholars Award 2021 Graduate Teaching Assistantship, Colorado State University 2017 – 2023 Colorado College Financial Aid Award 2013 – 2017 Davis United World College Scholars Scholarship Award 2013 – 2017 United World College of Southeast Asia Scholarship Award 2008 – 2013
CONFERENCES	Eastern Economic Association, La Romana, Dominican Republic 2026 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management, Seattle, WA 2025 Southern Economic Association 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL 2025 14th Annual Conference on Teaching and Research in Economic Education, Denver 2025 Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C. 2024 The 70th Meetings of the North American Regional Science Council, San Diego, CA 2023 The 3rd Annual Conference of the Western Social Science Association 2021 (virtual) 2021
OTHER CONFERENCE ACTIVITIES	Eastern Economic Association, La Romana, Dominican Republic, <i>Discussant</i> 2026 ASSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA, <i>Session Chair: Artificial Intelligence</i> 2026 Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C., <i>Discussant</i> 2024 70th Meetings of the North American Regional Science Council, San Diego, CA, <i>Discussant</i> 2023
WORKSHOPS	7th Annual Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, FRB Atlanta, Orlando 2025 6th Annual Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, FRB Atlanta, Clemson 2024
MEDIA MENTIONS	Huss, Phoebe. “Once given out at USC, this banned, opioid-like product is still cropping up in California.” <i>CalMatters</i> , March 17, 2026.

Reddy, Sumathi. “What You Need to Know About Kratom.” *Wall Street Journal*, August 16, 2025.

“Teresa Perry, PhD: Academic Paper on the Rise of Kratom Tonic Products.” *Kratom Sobriety Podcast*, episode 46.

INVITED TALKS	Colorado College Economic Department Seminar Series	2026
	Dickinson College Economic Department Seminar Series	2025
	AI in Economics Seminar Series at Royal Holloway, University of London (virtual)	2025
	Keynote Speaker, APIME Graduation Celebration at Lafayette College	2025
	Faculty Features: A Roundtable Celebrating Lafayette Faculty Scholarship and Creativity	2025
	Asian Cultural Association at Lafayette College	2024, 2025
	The Hanson Center for Inclusive STEM Education at Lafayette College	2024
	University of Wyoming, Knox College, University of New Hampshire	2023

SKILLS AND **Programming/Software**

CREDENTIALS Proficient in: Python, R, Stata, MySQL, Git/GitHub

Certifications

Good Clinical Practice Training for Social and Behavioral Research, Tools for Data Science, Python for Data Science, Python for Data Science & AI, Data Science Methodology, Database & SQL for Data Science, Data Analysis with Python, Machine Learning with Python, Data Visualization with Python, Python Project for Data Science

PROFESSIONAL American Economic Association, American Society of Health Economists
AFFILIATIONS

PROFESSIONAL Referee for: *International Journal of Mental Health and Addiction, Regulation & Governance,*
SERVICE *Eastern Economic Journal, Journal of Family and Economic Issues, Economics and Human Biology, Energy Economics, World Development*

External reviewer: Ph.D. Dissertation at Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur